

YOUR MAP'S YEAR

You put your camps, your art, and yourselves on this map, and it grew into something none of us quite planned. Here's what it became, what we built for you during the week – and, because you deserve the truth more than the highlight reel, what broke.

1,247

CAMPS ON THE MAP

361

ARTWORKS PLACED

~1,700

EVENTS LISTED

0

TRACKERS & ADS,
EVER

WHAT THE MAP BECAME

It started the season holding **236 camps** – the ones who found us and placed themselves. During event week we added Burning Man's own public placement directory (~1,000 more camps, converted from addresses like "7:30 & E" by our geocoder) and the official art directory, so the map finally showed **the whole city**. One rule governed the merge, and always will: **a pin placed by a person beats the official spreadsheet, every time**. Not one of your placements was moved. You can hide the directory camps with one switch in Layers if you only want to see who opted in.

All of it worked offline – the map draws itself with no tiles and no signal, which is the only kind of map that means anything out there.

WHAT WE BUILT FOR YOU, AS THE WEEK DEMANDED IT

- **Weather you could act on** – the pill led with real sensors inside the fence (thanks, BRC NOC), said the dust risk in words – "*Dusty – goggles up*" – and the map itself blew and rained to match the real sky.
- **Radio that follows you** – BMIR and Shouting Fire, one tap from the map, on a player that keeps playing while you browse. Plus the official webcast on /live.
- **Rideshares** (launched the night before exodus) – offer seats or ask for one, arrange it in messages, and use **Connect** to share live locations with exactly one other person until either of you taps stop – at which point both positions are deleted, not hidden. We also mirrored RideFinder's listings so you saw every ride in one place. The board's first post helped a stranger get toward home; that's the whole point.

- **Exodus, honestly** – a page where people actually in the line tapped how long Gate Road was taking, and the road on the homepage wore the answer in colour: green breathing when it flowed, red when it didn't, *nothing at all* when reports went stale – because a confident stale number is how surges start. Little taillights crawled out Gate Road, one for every open ride post, at the reported pace.
- **Your people, off-grid** – pair a Meshtastic radio and campmates appear on the map with chat, no internet at all.
- **Resto** (live now) – standing on MOOP? Pin it anonymously at brcmap.net/resto and a line sweep can find it. Leave No Trace is a group project.

And what we didn't build: ads, trackers, or anything that knows who you are. Visit counting forgets you at playa midnight – that's arithmetic, not a promise.

WHAT BROKE (THE PART MOST REPORTS LEAVE OUT)

The scariest one: for a few minutes mid-exodus, our mirror of the official traffic account showed posts from 2023's mud-year closure – "do not travel to Black Rock City" – as if they were live. The account had been dormant for three years and our code didn't know a feed could answer with old news. Caught and fixed within minutes; old posts can never impersonate live ones now. If you saw it: that was us, and we're sorry.

The top of the map spent days being messy. A gate-status pill that never had data behind it, then a weather banner that overlapped things, then a status bar with a long empty tail, then two green dots nobody could decode. We rebuilt it until the layout couldn't collide by construction and every dot became a word. Your screenshots drove every fix – keep sending them.

K-Hole never streamed. We added the station, then its play button only ever apologised – their internet stream was down all week. We removed the button rather than leave it lying. The tune-in info is still on /live for when they're back.

Batch email was broken – which you may have noticed as... silence. Announcements died partway through sending, which is why some of you got past emails and some didn't. Rebuilt from scratch: this very email arrived via the new system, delivered a few per minute so nobody gets doubles.

One artwork briefly had two pins ~22 m apart (a typo'd name met the official directory). The artist's own pin won, as the rules require.

NEXT YEAR, IF YOU'LL HAVE US

The exodus meter before gate opens, deeper rideshare integration, a way for artists to claim their pieces again, and the wilder ideas we hope you'll reply with. Tell us what glitched for *you*, what was useful, what should exist – just reply to the email that brought you here. Every reply gets read by a human.

Your camp, art, and placements stay up all year. If anything changed during the week, update it while you remember.

BRC Map (brcmap.net) is an unofficial community project · Pins are approximate; only Placement places camps and only the ARTery places art · Built by burners in partnership with an AI pair – the long version of this report, through the eyes of a traffic engineer, the Org, and law enforcement, lives at brcmap.net/aar-2026.pdf